

Late in 1935 he had learned that his technical superior in the field of nickels had agreed to shift Farben's largest nickel plant from Western to Central Germany and to expand production and "to stockpile as large a nickel ore in Germany as possible - - in event of war." He knew, too, that tungsten production was being similarly transferred. Hermann Schmitz had said that as early as 1933 he, Haefliger, had "been engaged in various ~~organ~~ negotiations of a strictly confidential nature with the German Ministry of War, especially in the inorganic departments."

But, he said, the Technical mobilization plans were unknown to him as a commercial man. He was surprised that the Prosecution had got an affidavit from a Reich official stating that in 1934, he, Paul Haefliger, had been the Farben representative to the Reich Office of Chemistry "about questions in defense-economy and the setting up of mobilization plans for war."

"What have you to say to that?" *his counsel asked.*

"This assertion is a mistake. I did not attend any such negotiations....The only discussions about any mobilization plans at the Commercial Committee meetings were about deferments from military service."

One thing was certain: Haefliger's second residence in Berlin could not have been much of a haven from the Frankfurt clique of directors. The feeling of being shut out must have been pursuing him in Berlin, too, years before the war. For ~~in~~ 1937 - - the year Krauch finally joined the Nazi Party, the year Ger Meer joined the Party and then showed a strange reluctance to visit the VW after he had left it under a subordinate - - ^{*was the year*} - (Farben's Commercial Committee, which had long met in Frankfurt, moved into Berlin Northwest 7. At Frankfurt the Committee had met perhaps once every 7 weeks; in August they began holding regular monthly meetings. von Schnitzler announced that these Berlin meetings would take up questions of "political economy and defense politics."

von Schnitzler was the cause of his present plight.